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# EPA Ghana

## Integrated Permit & Management System

(IPMS)

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### Employee Operations Manual

Environmental Protection Authority – Ghana

**Version:** 1.0  
**Audience:** Internal Staff  
**Updated:** May 2026  
**System:** IPMS v1.0

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*This manual is intended for internal EPA Ghana staff only.  
For client-facing guidance, refer to the EPA Client Portal User Guide.*

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## 1. Introduction

The **Integrated Permit & Management System (IPMS)** is EPA Ghana’s internal platform for receiving, processing, reviewing, and issuing permits, licenses, and other regulatory authorisations. This manual explains step-by-step how EPA staff — from processing officers to the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) — use the system to move an application from submission to final issuance.

**Application types handled by the system:**

- **Permit Applications** (e.g., environmental permit, import pesticide, hazardous waste, etc.)
- **License Applications** (e.g., pesticide import, pesticide distribution, commercial, etc.)
- **Authorization Requests** (e.g., pesticide authorization)
- **Bio-Efficacy Trials (Efficacy Trial Applications)**

Every application submitted by a client on the EPA Client Portal enters this system and must be processed through a defined workflow managed under the **Assignment Plan**.

## 2. Getting Started – The Dashboard

When you log in, you are taken to the **Admin Dashboard**, which gives you a real-time overview of:

**tableHead**

|                                 |                                                          |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Total Invoiced</b>           | Total monetary value of all generated invoices           |
| <b>rowAlt Revenue Collected</b> | Total payments received from clients                     |
| <b>Outstanding Amount</b>       | Invoices that are unpaid                                 |
| <b>rowAlt Total Invoices</b>    | Count of all invoices generated                          |
| <b>Permits Overview</b>         | Total, New, Renewal, Expiring Soon, and Expired permits  |
| <b>rowAlt Licenses Overview</b> | Total, New, Renewal, Expiring Soon, and Expired licenses |
| <b>Permits by Department</b>    | Breakdown of permits handled per department              |
| <b>rowAlt Permits by Type</b>   | Breakdown by permit type                                 |
| <b>Permits by Status</b>        | Active vs. Expired counts                                |

Tip

Use the **date filter** (This Month / Custom Range) at the top right of the dashboard to adjust the reporting period displayed.

### 3. Managing Team Members & Permissions

The **Team Members** page (found under **Personal** → **Team Members** in the sidebar) allows the **Head of Department (HOD)** to manage all staff within their department — viewing their profiles, changing their employment status, and granting or revoking system permissions.

Note

**Who can access this?** Only the HOD (or a staff member explicitly granted elevated access) can see and manage team members in their department.

#### 3.1 Viewing Team Members

When you navigate to **Team Members**, you see a paginated table of all staff in your department with the following columns:

| tableHead       |                                                                          |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| #               | Row number                                                               |
| rowAlt Staff ID | Unique staff identifier; HOD staff are tagged with an orange “HOD” badge |
| Name            | Staff full name with initials avatar                                     |
| rowAlt Grade    | Staff grade/level within EPA                                             |
| Entity / Unit   | The department or unit the staff belongs to                              |
| rowAlt Email    | Staff email address                                                      |
| Phone           | Staff phone number                                                       |
| rowAlt Status   | Active (green) or Retired/Inactive (red)                                 |
| Actions         | <b>Change Status</b> and <b>Permissions</b> buttons                      |

Use the **Search box** to find a staff member by name or ID. Use the **Sort** arrows on the Staff ID and Name columns to order the list.

#### 3.2 Changing a Staff Member’s Status

If a staff member retires, resigns, or needs to be deactivated:

1. Locate the staff member in the **Team Members** list.
2. Click the **Change Status** button on their row.
3. In the modal that appears, select the new status (e.g., Active, Retired, etc.).
4. Click **Confirm**.

The staff member's status is updated immediately and reflected in the table with the appropriate colour badge.

#### Important

Deactivating a staff member does not delete their records. All their historical work and assignments remain in the system for audit purposes.

### 3.3 Granting Permissions to Staff

By default, a new staff member has no special system permissions — they can log in and view only what their role entitles them to. The HOD must explicitly **grant permissions** to enable specific capabilities.

#### Steps to grant/update permissions:

1. Locate the staff member in the **Team Members** list.
2. Click the **Permissions** button (lock icon) on their row.
3. The “**Update Permissions**” modal opens, showing the staff member's name at the top and a checklist of all available permissions.
4. **Check** the boxes for permissions you want to grant.
5. **Uncheck** any boxes for permissions you want to revoke.
6. Click **Save Permissions**.

A success notification confirms the update. The permissions take effect immediately on the staff member's next action.

#### Note

The HOD does not need to grant permissions to themselves — as a department head (`is_head = true`), they automatically have full access to all assignment and workflow management features within their department.

### 3.4 Available Permissions Explained

The following permissions can be granted to any staff member in your department:

tableHead

|                              |                                     |                                                                                                      |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Access Assignment Plan       | <code>assignment_plan</code>        | Can view and access the Assignment Plan to see all applications being processed in the department    |
| rowAlt Assign Tasks          | <code>assign_task</code>            | Can assign stages to officers from the Assignment Plan (typically used when delegating the HOD role) |
| Review Completed Assignments | <code>review_completed_tasks</code> | Can review and validate tasks marked as completed by an officer                                      |

tableHead

|                                    |                                   |                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| rowAlt Reject Applications (Final) | <code>reject_applications</code>  | Can permanently reject an application — rejected applications are closed and <b>cannot be resubmitted or reassigned</b> |
| View Invoices                      | <code>view_invoices</code>        | Can view all invoices generated for applications                                                                        |
| rowAlt Payment Transactions        | <code>account_transcripts</code>  | Can review full transaction history and monitor all payment activities                                                  |
| Transfer Applications              | <code>transfer_application</code> | Can transfer an application to another organisational entity                                                            |
| rowAlt Registered Clients          | <code>registered_clients</code>   | Can view and manage all clients registered within the system                                                            |
| Payroll Verification               | <code>payroll_validation</code>   | Can review and verify employee payroll records before payroll processing runs                                           |

#### Best Practice

**Principle of Least Privilege:** Only grant the permissions a staff member needs for their specific duties.

- A **regular processing officer** typically needs no special permissions — they will receive tasks via the normal assignment workflow.
- A **senior officer** who assists with task management may need `assignment_plan` + `assign_task`.
- A **finance officer** reviewing fees should be given `view_invoices` + `account_transcripts`.
- **Transfer Applications** should only be granted to trusted senior staff who redirect applications between departments.
- **Reject Applications (Final)** is a high-impact permission reserved for authorised decision-makers only, as rejections are **irreversible**.

## 4. Permit Management – Applications

The **Permit Management** section in the left-hand sidebar gives you access to:

- **Applications** (Permit, License, Authorization Requests, Bio-Efficacy Trials)
- **Authorization Requests**
- **Bio Efficacy Trials**
- **Permit Registry**
- **Configuration**

## 4.1 Viewing Applications

Navigate to **Permit Management** → **Applications** (or the specific type: License Applications, Authorization Requests, Efficacy Trials).

Each row in the applications table displays:

- **Reference Code** – Unique application identifier (e.g., EPA-PA-0001)
- **Applicant / Organisation Name**
- **Permit Type** – The type of permit being applied for
- **Category** – Sub-category of the permit type
- **Assigned Department** – Which EPA department is handling it
- **Submission Date**
- **Current Status** – Colour-coded badge (see Section 12 for status glossary)
- **Action Buttons** – View, View Assignment Plan, Transfer, Transfer History

## 4.2 Searching and Filtering Applications

Use the toolbar at the top of the applications list to narrow down records:

tableHead

|                                 |                                                      |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Search Box</b>               | Search by application code, title, or applicant name |
| <b>rowAlt Status Filter</b>     | Filter by current processing status                  |
| <b>Permit Type</b>              | Filter by permit/license type                        |
| <b>rowAlt Department Filter</b> | Filter by the handling department                    |
| <b>Date Range Picker</b>        | Filter by submission date range                      |
| <b>rowAlt Sort</b>              | Sort by date ascending or descending                 |

Click the **Reload** button () to refresh the list manually.

## 4.3 Viewing Application Details

Click the **Eye icon** on any application row to open the **Application Preview**. This drawer/modal shows:

- Applicant information (name, organisation, contact)
- Full application form answers and attachments
- Supporting documents uploaded by the applicant
- Application status history



## 4.4 Viewing the Assignment Plan of an Application

Click the **Assignment Plan** icon on any application row to view the **Assignment Plan Modal**. This shows:

- The complete workflow history for that application
- Which officer handled each stage
- Stage statuses: `in_progress`, `completed`, `skipped`, `reverted`, `recalled`, `rejected`
- Notes at each stage
- Timestamps (started, completed, reviewed)

### Note

This is useful for supervisors to track exactly where an application is in its processing journey.

## 4.5 Transferring an Application

Applications may need to be transferred from one department to another (e.g., when a permit application falls under a different division's jurisdiction).

### Steps to transfer:

1. Locate the application in the list.
2. Click the **Transfer** button (swap/arrow icon).
3. In the **Transfer Modal**, select the target department.
4. Provide a reason/note for the transfer.
5. Click **Confirm Transfer**.

The application will now appear under the receiving department's queue and disappear from the current department's active list.

### Note

Only authorised users (typically Heads of Department or users with transfer permissions) can transfer applications.

## 4.6 Transfer History

To view all past transfers for an application:

1. Click the **Transfer History** icon (clock/history icon) on the application row.
2. A **Transfer History Drawer** will slide open showing:
  - The date and time of each transfer
  - Which department sent it
  - Which department received it
  - The officer who performed the transfer
  - Notes provided at the time of transfer

## 4.7 Application History

Within the **Assignment Plan Modal**, scroll to the **History** section to see a full chronological audit log of all actions taken on an application:

- Stage assignments and completions
- Reviews (approved, rework, skip, revert)
- Invoice proposals and approvals
- Report requests and acknowledgements
- Rejections

Each history entry shows **who performed the action** and **when**.

## 5. Permit Registry

Navigate to **Permit Management** → **Permit Registry** to view all issued permits and licenses.

### What the Registry Shows

tableHead

|                                        |                                                               |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Permit Number</b>                   | Unique permit reference issued by EPA                         |
| <b>rowAlt Applicant / Organisation</b> | Client who was granted the permit                             |
| <b>Permit Type</b>                     | Type of permit (e.g., import pesticide, environmental permit) |
| <b>rowAlt Issue Date</b>               | Date the permit was officially signed and issued              |
| <b>Expiry Date</b>                     | Date the permit expires                                       |
| <b>rowAlt Status</b>                   | ACTIVE, EXPIRED, PENDING (pending CEO signature)              |
| <b>Department</b>                      | Issuing department                                            |

### Registry Features

- **Search** – Search by permit number, applicant name, or permit type
- **Filter by Status** – Active, Expired, Pending
- **Filter by Permit Type** – Narrow to a specific permit category
- **Filter by Date Range** – Filter by Issue Date, Expiry Date, or Created Date
- **Filter by Department**
- **Export** – Download permits data to Excel
- **Statistics Modal** – View aggregate data and charts

- **View Permit PDF** – Click the PDF icon to view or download the official permit document
- **Sign Permit** – For the CEO: a button to digitally sign and activate a permit (see Section 9)

## 6. The Assignment Plan – A Complete Guide

### 6.1 Overview – What is the Assignment Plan?

The **Assignment Plan** is the core workflow engine in IPMS. When a client submits an application, the system automatically creates an Assignment Plan record for that application. This plan defines the sequential stages that must be completed before a permit or license can be issued.

Think of it as a **digital processing file** that tracks every step of the review process.

### 6.2 Who Uses the Assignment Plan?

| tableHead                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Head of Department (HOD)  | Views all pending assignments in their department, assigns each stage to an officer, reviews completed stages, approves/rejects/skips/reverts stages, requests corrections, and manages the overall workflow. |
| rowAlt Processing Officer | Receives assignment notifications, reviews the application, performs the work for their assigned stage, and marks the stage as complete.                                                                      |
| CEO / Approving Authority | Signs the permit in the registry after the issuance stage is approved.                                                                                                                                        |

### 6.3 The Workflow Stages Explained

Every application passes through up to **5 sequential stages**:

|                             |                                       |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| [SUBMITTED]                 |                                       |
|                             |                                       |
| Stage 1: PROCESSING FEE     | (Invoice prepared and sent to client) |
|                             |                                       |
|                             | [Client Pays Processing Fee]          |
|                             |                                       |
| Stage 2: COMPLETENESS CHECK |                                       |
|                             |                                       |
| Stage 3: EVALUATION         |                                       |
|                             |                                       |
| Stage 4: PERMIT FEE         | (Invoice prepared and sent to client) |
|                             |                                       |
|                             | [Client Pays Permit Fee]              |
|                             |                                       |
| Stage 5: ISSUANCE           |                                       |

```

|
[PENDING CEO SIGNATURE --> CEO SIGNS --> PERMIT ACTIVE]

```

Each stage follows this mini-cycle:

```

HOD Assigns Stage to Officer
|
Officer Works & Completes Stage
|
HOD Reviews Completed Work
|
HOD Approves --> Advances to Next Stage
OR
HOD Requests Rework --> Officer Revises
OR
HOD Returns to Applicant --> Client Provides Corrections

```

## 6.4 Stage 1 – Processing Fee

**Purpose:** Determine and invoice the processing fee for the application immediately upon receipt. This fee covers the administrative and technical review costs and is collected before any substantive review begins.

### Officer Tasks:

- Open the Working Area for the assignment
- Click on the **Invoice Preparation Panel**
- Add line items to the invoice (see Section 8 for full invoicing instructions)
- Each line item requires: **Service Description, Service Code, Quantity, Unit Price**
- The system automatically calculates the **Subtotal** and **Total**
- When done, click **Complete Stage & Submit Invoice**

**HOD Review:** If approved, the system:

- Generates an official invoice
- Integrates with the **Ghana.Gov payment gateway** to create a payment link
- Sends the invoice + payment link to the client via **SMS and Email**
- **Immediately advances the assignment to Completeness Check** (concurrent processing) while the client arranges payment
- Sets an **orange “Awaiting Processing Fee” badge** on the assignment card

**After Payment:** Once the client makes payment through Ghana.Gov, the system confirms automatically and the badge turns **green** (“**Processing Fee Paid**”). Processing continues uninterrupted.

## 6.5 Stage 2 – Completeness Check

**Purpose:** Verify that the application is complete — all required fields are filled in and all required supporting documents have been uploaded.

**Officer Tasks:**

- Open the application (full form view is available in the Working Area)
- Review all submitted information against the application requirements
- Check that all required attachments (certificates, TINs, site plans, etc.) are present and valid
- Add comments in the **Comments** section if needed
- When satisfied, click **Complete Stage** and provide completion notes

**HOD Review:** After the officer completes this stage, the HOD reviews and either:

- **Approves** → Application moves to Evaluation stage
- **Requests Rework from Officer** → Officer re-examines the application
- **Returns to Applicant** → Client is notified to provide corrections or missing documents

**What the Client Sees:** If returned for corrections, the client receives an SMS and email notification stating the application requires corrections, with the HOD's notes explaining what is needed. The client logs into the Client Portal and resubmits the required information.

## 6.6 Stage 3 – Evaluation

**Purpose:** Technical review and assessment of the application. This is the most detailed stage where officers conduct in-depth evaluation.

**Officer Tasks:**

- Review all application data using the **Working Area** (relevant review form for the permit type)
- Officers may attach documents, complete checklists, and make technical determinations
- Add internal **comments** to the workflow step for team collaboration
- The HOD can request **reports from the client** during this stage (e.g., Scoping Reports, EIA reports, site verification reports) — see Section 7.10
- When evaluation is complete, click **Complete Stage** with detailed notes

**HOD Review:** After officer completion, the HOD can:

- **Approve** (moves to Permit Fee stage)
- Request **Rework** from the officer
- **Return to Applicant** for corrections
- **Skip** or **Revert** as appropriate

## 6.7 Stage 4 – Permit Fee

**Purpose:** Determine and invoice the permit issuance fee. This is the fee charged for the actual permit/license document.

This stage works identically to the Processing Fee stage (see Sections 6.4 and 8):

- The officer prepares the permit fee invoice with line items
- The HOD reviews and approves
- Upon approval, an official invoice is generated and sent to the client
- The assignment **immediately advances to Issuance** (concurrent processing) while the client arranges payment
- A purple “**Awaiting Permit Fee**” badge appears on the card; once payment is confirmed it turns **green**

## 6.8 Stage 5 – Issuance

**Purpose:** Prepare the permit/license document for formal issuance.

**Officer Tasks:**

- Open the **Issuance Panel** in the Working Area
- Verify all information is correct (applicant details, permit conditions, validity period, etc.)
- Mark the stage as complete

**HOD Review:** Upon approval, the system:

- Updates the permit/license record to “**PENDING**” status (pending CEO signature)
- The permit now appears in the **Permit Registry** awaiting the CEO’s signature

# 7. HOD Actions on the Assignment Plan

## 7.1 Assigning a Stage to an Officer

When an application is in a `pending*_assignment` status, the HOD must assign it to an officer.

1. Go to **Assignments** → **Assignment Plan** in the sidebar.
2. The list shows all applications awaiting action in your department. Use the status filter “**Pending Assignments**” to see all un-assigned stages.
3. Click **Assign** on the desired application.
4. In the **Assign Modal**:
  - Select the **Officer** from your department’s staff list
  - (Optional) Select **Copied Employees** — additional officers who are copied on this task for awareness
  - Set a **Deadline** date (and optionally, a specific time)

- Add **Notes** to guide the officer on what to focus on
- Toggle checkboxes if the application **Requires Analysis**, **Requires Inspection**, or **Requires Public Hearing**

5. Click **Confirm Assignment**.

The selected officer immediately receives an **in-app notification** informing them of the assignment.

#### Note

**Copied Employees** can view the task in their My Assignments section but cannot mark it as complete — only the primary assignee can complete the stage.

## 7.2 Reviewing a Completed Stage

When an officer completes their stage, the assignment's status changes to **review\_\*** (e.g., **review\_completeness\_check**). The HOD sees this in the **“Review”** filter.

1. Filter the Assignment Plan by status **“Review”**.
2. Click on the application.
3. Click the **Review** button to open the **Review Modal**.
4. Review the officer's completion notes and any attached work.
5. Select one of the available actions (see below).

## 7.3 Approving a Stage

**Action:** Select **“Approve”** in the Review Modal.

- For standard stages (Completeness Check, Evaluation, Issuance): the application automatically advances to the next pending stage.
- For fee stages (Processing Fee, Permit Fee): approving generates and sends the official invoice to the client and concurrently advances to the next stage.

Provide notes documenting your approval decision.

## 7.4 Sending Work Back for Rework (Officer)

**Action:** Select **“Request Rework from Officer”** in the Review Modal.

Use this when the officer's work is incomplete or incorrect and needs to be revised by the same officer.

- The stage is marked **“Reverted”** and a new in-progress step is created for the same officer
- The officer receives a notification explaining what needs to be corrected
- Notes you provide are sent to the officer as instructions

The officer will revise their work and complete the stage again for your re-review.

## 7.5 Requesting Corrections from the Applicant/Client

**Action:** Select **“Return to Applicant for Corrections”** in the Review Modal, OR use the **“Request Corrections”** button at any point during the process.

Use this when additional information or documents are required from the applicant before processing can continue.

**What happens immediately:**

- The application status changes to “**Corrections Required**”
- A **Corrections Pending** blocker (red badge) is recorded against the assignment
- The client receives an **SMS and email notification** with your correction notes explaining what is needed
- **The workflow continues concurrently** — any stage that is not actively **in progress** can still be assigned and worked on while the applicant makes their corrections

**What the director/HOD sees on the assignment card:**

- A red “**Corrections Pending**” badge is displayed on the card while the client has not yet resubmitted
- Once the client resubmits their application, the badge turns **green** and reads “**Corrections Submitted**” so the director can see at a glance that the obligation has been fulfilled

**Note**

This can also be used proactively (not just during review) via the “**Request Corrections**” action in the assignment action menu. The only restriction is that a stage which is currently **in progress** must be completed by the officer before a decision to return to the applicant can be made.

**Important**

**Concurrent Processing:** The system no longer places the entire assignment “On Hold” when corrections are requested. Officers can continue working on other active stages while the applicant resolves their corrections. This eliminates unnecessary delays in the review timeline.

## 7.6 Skipping a Stage

Sometimes a stage is not applicable for a specific application type. The HOD can skip it.

1. Locate the application with a **pending\*\_assignment** status.
2. Click **Actions** → **Skip Stage**.
3. Provide a **mandatory reason/note** explaining why the stage is being skipped.
4. Confirm.

The stage is logged as “**Skipped**” in the history, and the workflow automatically advances to the next stage.



**Note**

**Example:** The Processing Fee stage may be skipped for government or statutory body applications that are exempt from fees.

## 7.7 Reverting to a Previous Stage

If the HOD needs to send the application back to a previous stage (not just to the officer, but back to the full previous stage including re-assignment):

1. Locate the application in a `pending*_assignment` status.
2. Click **Actions** → **Revert to Previous Stage**.
3. Provide a **mandatory reason/note**.
4. Confirm.

The previous stage becomes active again (`pending*_assignment`) and must be re-assigned to an officer. The workflow steps for any stages after the revert point are marked as “**Reverted**” in the audit trail.

**Note**

**Example:** If evaluation is pending but new information requires the completeness check to be redone, the HOD reverts to Completeness Check.

## 7.8 Recalling an Assigned Stage

If a stage has already been assigned to an officer (status: `*_in_progress`) but the HOD needs to reassign it:

1. Locate the application with an `*_in_progress` status.
2. Click **Actions** → **Recall Stage**.
3. Provide a **mandatory reason/note**.
4. Confirm.
  - The current officer’s assignment is marked as “**Recalled**”
  - The assignment reverts to `pending*_assignment`
  - The HOD can now reassign the stage to a different officer

**Note**

**When to use:** If an assigned officer is unavailable, made an error, or needs to be replaced on a particular stage.

## 7.9 Rejecting an Application

If an application cannot proceed (e.g., the applicant does not meet statutory requirements):

1. Locate the application in any pending or in-progress state.
2. Click **Actions** → **Reject Application**.

3. Provide a **mandatory and detailed rejection reason**.

4. Confirm.

The system:

- Marks the application and assignment as “**Rejected**”
- Sends an **SMS and email notification** to the client with the rejection reason
- Logs the rejection in the application history

#### Important

Rejection is **permanent and irreversible** from within the system. Use this action only after all other options have been exhausted and the decision is final.

## 7.10 Requesting Reports from the Client

During the **Evaluation stage** (or any active stage), the HOD may need the client to submit specific technical reports before the evaluation can be concluded.

**Common report types include:**

- **Scoping Report** – Initial study to define the scope of an Environmental Impact Assessment
- **Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) Report**
- **Environmental Management Plan (EMP)**
- **Site Verification Report**
- **Performance Audit Report (PAR)**
- **Any other custom report type**

1. In the Assignment Plan view, click **Actions** → **Request Reports from Client**.

2. In the modal that appears:

- Select the **Report Types** required (one or more from the list of report templates configured in the system)
- Set a **Due Date** by which the client must submit
- Provide **Notes/Instructions** to the client explaining what is needed
- (Optional) Attach a **Reference Document** (e.g., a Terms of Reference PDF) that the client should follow

3. Click **Submit Request**.

**What happens immediately:**

- The application status changes to “**Reports Required**”
- A **Reports Pending** blocker (blue badge) is recorded against the assignment
- The client receives an **SMS and email notification** with the list of required reports, the due date, your instructions, and a link to the portal

- The client logs into the EPA Client Portal, finds their application, and uploads the reports under the **Report Requirements** section
- **The workflow continues concurrently** — other pending stages can still be assigned and progressed while reports are awaited

#### What the director/HOD sees on the assignment card:

- A blue **“Reports Pending”** badge is displayed on the card while the client has not yet uploaded
- Once the client uploads their reports, the badge turns **green** and reads **“Reports Submitted”** so the director can see immediately that the obligation has been met

#### Important

**Concurrent Processing:** The assignment is no longer placed “On Hold” when reports are requested. EPA officers may continue processing the application in parallel. This allows EPA to maintain momentum without waiting idly for client submissions.

### 7.11 Acknowledging Submitted Reports

When the client submits their reports, the HOD receives a notification and must review them.

1. Open the Assignment Plan for the application.
2. Navigate to the **Report Requirements** section.
3. Find the submitted report requirement (status: **“Submitted”**).
4. Click **Acknowledge**.
5. Choose one of three actions:

#### tableHead

|                                |                                                             |                                                                      |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Approve</b>                 | Reports are satisfactory and complete                       | Application status returns to <b>under review</b> ; workflow resumes |
| <b>rowAlt Request Revision</b> | Reports are incomplete or need corrections                  | Client is notified to revise and resubmit; due date is updated       |
| <b>Reject</b>                  | Reports are unacceptable and the application cannot proceed | Application is rejected; client is notified                          |

Provide notes for any action. The client is automatically notified via SMS and email of your decision.

## 8. Invoicing – Processing Fee & Permit Fee

IPMS handles two types of fees during an application’s lifecycle:

#### tableHead

|                          |         |                                             |
|--------------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>Processing Fee</b>    | Stage 1 | Administrative and technical review cost    |
| <b>rowAlt Permit Fee</b> | Stage 4 | Cost of issuing the permit/license document |

Both fees follow the same invoicing process: an officer **proposes** the invoice, and the HOD **approves and officially issues** it.

## 8.1 Processing Fee Invoice

Raised during Stage 1 of the workflow. Once the HOD approves the invoice, the assignment **immediately advances to Completeness Check** (concurrent processing) while the client arranges payment. An **orange “Awaiting Processing Fee” badge** appears on the assignment card. Once Ghana.Gov confirms payment the badge turns **green (“Processing Fee Paid”)** and any remaining evaluation work continues uninterrupted.

## 8.2 Permit Fee Invoice

Raised during Stage 4. Once the HOD approves the invoice, the assignment **immediately advances to Issuance** (concurrent processing) while the client arranges payment. A **purple “Awaiting Permit Fee” badge** appears on the card. Once Ghana.Gov confirms payment the badge turns **green (“Permit Fee Paid”)** and the issuance stage continues.

## 8.3 How an Officer Prepares an Invoice

When an officer is assigned the **Processing Fee** or **Permit Fee** stage:

1. Open the assignment from **My Assignments**.
2. The **Invoice Preparation Panel** is displayed at the bottom of the Working Area.
3. Click **Add Line Item** to add a chargeable item.

For each line item, provide:

#### tableHead

|                                |                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Service Description</b>     | Human-readable name of the service/charge (e.g., “Application Review Fee”, “Environmental Assessment Fee”, “Site Inspection Fee”) |
| <b>rowAlt Service Code</b>     | The official EPA service code for this charge (from the configured service codes list)                                            |
| <b>Quantity</b>                | Number of units (e.g., 1 permit, 2 inspections)                                                                                   |
| <b>rowAlt Unit Price (GHS)</b> | Price per unit                                                                                                                    |

**tableHead**

|              |                                        |
|--------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>Total</b> | Auto-calculated: Quantity × Unit Price |
|--------------|----------------------------------------|

**Note**

**Multiple Line Items:** An invoice can have more than one line item. For example:

- Line 1: Application Review Fee — GHS 500.00
- Line 2: Environmental Assessment Fee — GHS 1,200.00
- Line 3: Site Inspection Fee — GHS 300.00
- **Total: GHS 2,000.00**

[resume]

4. The **Subtotal** and **Total** are calculated automatically.
5. Once all charges are entered, click **Complete Stage & Submit Invoice for Review**.

**Note**

A **Digital Service Charge** may be automatically added by the system to cover platform usage costs. This is appended by the HOD's approval workflow.

## 8.4 How the HOD Approves and Issues the Invoice

1. The assignment status changes to `review_processing_fee` or `review_permit_fee`.
2. The HOD opens the review and sees the proposed invoice with all line items.
3. If satisfactory, the HOD clicks **Approve**.

**Upon Approval, the system automatically:**

- Appends any applicable **Digital Service Charge** line item
- Sends the invoice to the **Ghana.Gov payment gateway** to create an official payment record
- Saves the invoice in the system with status **“Unpaid”**
- Sets a **30-day payment due date**
- Sends the client an **SMS and email** containing a summary of the invoice and a link to make payment via Ghana.Gov
- Records a **fee payment blocker** on the assignment (orange badge for processing fee; purple badge for permit fee)
- **Immediately advances the assignment** to the next workflow stage so that EPA officers can continue processing concurrently while the client arranges payment

**After the client pays**, the system webhook receives confirmation from Ghana.Gov, marks the invoice as **“Paid”**, resolves the fee blocker (badge turns green), and the assignment continues from wherever it currently is — no rollback or re-assignment is

required.

#### Note

If the assignment was created under the previous (legacy) workflow and was literally stuck awaiting payment, the system will automatically advance it to the correct next stage upon payment confirmation. No manual intervention is needed.

## 9. Issuance and CEO Signing

After the permit/license fee is paid and the Issuance stage is completed and approved by the HOD, the permit/license record is created with a status of “**PENDING**”. It now awaits the **CEO’s digital signature** to become officially active.

### How the CEO Signs a Permit

1. Navigate to **Permit Management** → **Permit Registry** (for permits) or the equivalent license registry.
2. Filter or find the permit/license with status “**PENDING**”.
3. Click the **Approve & Sign** button on the permit record.
4. Confirm the signing action in the dialog.

#### Upon Signing:

- The permit status changes to “**ACTIVE**”
- The permit document (PDF) is generated/updated with the approval details
- The client receives notification that their permit has been issued
- The permit is now legally valid and appears in the active permits registry

#### Important

Only the CEO (or a user with the `approve_sign_permit` privilege) can perform this action. This ensures all permits are authorised at the highest level before activation.

## 10. My Assignments – Officer Working Area

Processing officers find their assigned work under **Assignments** → **My Assignments**.

### Viewing Your Tasks

The **My Assignments** list shows tasks where you are either the **primary assignee** or a **copied employee**. By default, it shows tasks with status “**In Progress**” (tasks that need your action).

Use the status filter to view:

- **In Progress** – Tasks currently assigned to you (default view)
- **Completed** – Tasks you have finished
- **Recalled** – Tasks that were taken back by the HOD

- **Reverted** – Tasks that were reversed

## Opening a Task (Working Area)

Click on any task to open the **Working Area**. Here you will find:

### tableHead

|                                         |                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Application Info</b>                 | Summary of the application (code, applicant, permit type, submission date)                                          |
| <b>rowAlt Deadline Banner</b>           | Shows how many days until your task is due. Turns red when overdue.                                                 |
| <b>Task Details</b>                     | Your stage name, start date, notes from the HOD, and copied employees                                               |
| <b>rowAlt Application Review Form</b>   | The full application form filled by the client, displayed in a structured review format relevant to the permit type |
| <b>Document Management</b>              | View and download all attachments submitted by the applicant                                                        |
| <b>rowAlt Invoice Preparation Panel</b> | (For fee stages only) Prepare the invoice with line items                                                           |
| <b>Issuance Panel</b>                   | (For issuance stage only) Prepare the final issuance details                                                        |
| <b>rowAlt Comments Section</b>          | Add internal comments for team communication during the stage                                                       |
| <b>Complete Task Button</b>             | Submit your completed work to the HOD for review                                                                    |

## Adding Comments

During your stage, you can add comments to communicate with copied colleagues:

1. Scroll to the **Comments** section at the bottom of the Working Area.
2. Type your comment in the text box.
3. Click **Send**.

Comments are visible to all officers assigned or copied on the same step. You can also **edit** your own comments if needed.

## Completing Your Stage

When you have finished your work:

1. Click the **Complete Task** button (green button, usually at the top or bottom of the Working Area).
2. In the **Complete Task Modal**:
  - For standard stages: Enter your **Completion Notes** summarising your find-

ings and recommendations.

- For fee stages: Confirm that the invoice has been prepared correctly.

### 3. Click **Submit**.

The HOD is immediately notified that your stage is complete and ready for review.

## 11. Bulk Assignment

For efficiency, the HOD can assign multiple applications to multiple officers in one action.

1. In the **Assignment Plan** view, switch to the “**Pending Assignments**” filter.
2. Select multiple applications using the **checkboxes** on each card/row.
3. Click **Bulk Assign**.
4. In the **Bulk Assign Modal**:
  - Select one or more **Officers** (tasks are distributed in round-robin fashion)
  - Set a **Deadline**
  - Add **Notes**
  - Set the **internal status** that the selected applications should be in (e.g., all must be `pending_completeness_check_assignment`)
5. Confirm.

### Note

All selected applications must be at the same stage for bulk assignment to work. Applications in different stages must be assigned individually.

## 12. Quick Reference – Status Glossary

### Application Statuses

| tableHead                            |                                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>submitted</code>               | Application received; awaiting review                                                                                                    |
| rowAlt <code>under_review</code>     | Application is being actively processed (this is the primary active state; fee and correction blockers are tracked separately as badges) |
| <code>corrections_required</code>    | HOD has requested the applicant make corrections; workflow continues concurrently                                                        |
| rowAlt <code>reports_required</code> | HOD has requested reports from the applicant; workflow continues concurrently                                                            |
| <code>awaiting_issuance</code>       | Permit fee confirmed paid; permit being prepared for issuance                                                                            |



tableHead

|                                       |                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| rowAlt completed                      | Application fully processed; permit/license issued                                                                                       |
| rejected                              | Application rejected                                                                                                                     |
| rowAlt processing_fee_pending_payment | (Legacy only) Processing fee invoice sent; entire assignment was on hold awaiting payment. No longer generated in new-flow applications. |
| permit_fee_pending_payment            | (Legacy only) Permit fee invoice sent; entire assignment was on hold awaiting payment. No longer generated in new-flow applications.     |

## Assignment Internal Statuses

tableHead

|                                        |                                                 |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| pending_processing_fee_assignment      | Awaiting HOD to assign Processing Fee stage     |
| rowAlt processing_fee_in_progress      | Officer preparing Processing Fee invoice        |
| review_processing_fee                  | HOD reviewing proposed Processing Fee invoice   |
| rowAlt awaiting_processing_fee_payment | Invoice issued; waiting for client to pay       |
| pending_completeness_check_assignment  | Awaiting HOD to assign Completeness Check stage |
| rowAlt completeness_check_in_progress  | Officer performing Completeness Check           |
| review_completeness_check              | HOD reviewing completed Completeness Check      |
| rowAlt pending_evaluation_assignment   | Awaiting HOD to assign Evaluation stage         |
| evaluation_in_progress                 | Officer performing technical Evaluation         |
| rowAlt review_evaluation               | HOD reviewing completed Evaluation              |
| pending_permit_fee_assignment          | Awaiting HOD to assign Permit Fee stage         |
| rowAlt permit_fee_in_progress          | Officer preparing Permit Fee invoice            |
| review_permit_fee                      | HOD reviewing proposed Permit Fee invoice       |

tableHead

|                                    |                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| rowAlt awaiting_permit_fee_payment | Invoice issued; waiting for client to pay                                                                                     |
| pending_issuance_assignment        | Awaiting HOD to assign Issuance stage                                                                                         |
| rowAlt issuance_in_progress        | Officer preparing permit for issuance                                                                                         |
| review_issuance                    | HOD reviewing issuance package                                                                                                |
| rowAlt completed                   | Workflow fully completed                                                                                                      |
| on_hold                            | <i>(Legacy only)</i> Entire assignment was frozen pending corrections or reports. Superseded by the concurrent blocker model. |
| rowAlt rejected                    | Application and assignment rejected                                                                                           |

## Active Blockers (Client Obligation Badges)

Active Blockers are indicators displayed as coloured badges on each assignment card. They record outstanding client obligations without halting the workflow. Each blocker has two visual states:

tableHead

|                            |        |                         |                       |
|----------------------------|--------|-------------------------|-----------------------|
| Corrections from applicant | Red    | Corrections Pending     | Corrections Submitted |
| rowAlt Reports from client | Blue   | Reports Pending         | Reports Submitted     |
| Processing fee payment     | Orange | Awaiting Processing Fee | Processing Fee Paid   |
| rowAlt Permit fee payment  | Purple | Awaiting Permit Fee     | Permit Fee Paid       |

Blockers are resolved automatically by the system when the client fulfils the obligation (resubmits corrections, uploads reports, or completes payment via Ghana.Gov). The badge changes from its pending colour to **green** so the director can see at a glance that the client has acted — without the card disappearing or the information being lost.

## Workflow Step Statuses

tableHead

|                  |                                    |
|------------------|------------------------------------|
| in_progress      | Step currently assigned and active |
| rowAlt completed | Step finished by officer           |
| reverted         | Step reversed by HOD               |

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tableHead

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|                   |                                     |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------|
| rowAlt recalled   | Step recalled from officer by HOD   |
| skipped           | Stage skipped by HOD                |
| rowAlt rejected   | Application rejected at this step   |
| reports_requested | Reports were requested at this step |

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*This manual is intended for internal EPA Ghana staff only. For client-facing guidance, refer to the EPA Client Portal User Guide. For system administration and configuration, refer to the System Administrator Manual.*

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